traditional Congress's 'politics of accommodation'. It has given greater representation to smaller sub-castes within the Dalits and the Other Backward Castes, and made a stronger pitch for social justice. Similarly, although the 'Nehruvian Consensus' created a progressive language, it offered only limited social mobility and transformation. The BJP has exploited that limitation to push for more conservative politics (socially and culturally), but in the name of radical change (political accommodation and welfarism). Rahul Gandhi has called their bluff in consistently arguing for two Indias—one for the rich marked by crony capitalism and one for the poor. It is a replay of an old tension referred to as Bharat-versus-India. Rahul Gandhi has projected a left-of-centre politics, which was the need of the hour. In fact, the Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) became a possibility because Rahul could project an image beyond electoral calculations and cost–benefit analysis. The BJY, in many ways, was a testimony to this. Rahul Gandhi looks more determined and charged up in his fight for a larger cause than in power mongering. This is dialectics of history at its best. But its gravest challenge is to translate it into everyday organizational ethics. This is certainly a long-drawn struggle that the Congress should invest in if it's to fight for an alternative idea of India.

In an earlier experiment of forging the National Advisory Council (NAC) under the Congress-led United Progressive Alliance (UPA) government from 2004 to 2014, the Congress attempted a progressive social legislation. Inclusive policies such as the right to employment were the reason the Congress came back to power in 2009. It was again with the help of the role of social activists in the NAC. However, in spite of successful social policies, this vision did not get reflected in the Congress party's working. Its cadre, and local and regional leaders did not know how to own this vision. This inability to translate a progressive vision into the party's organizational culture was partly responsible for the electoral results in 2014. Ironically, Indians did not identify Congress workers with Congress policies.

It was in this context that I remember being part of a meeting at the Rajiv Gandhi Foundation to explore the possibility of helping Congress